

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 2 · Citizen Participation (GC.31–GC.34)

Match the task to the tool —
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put steps in order / show a process	● Timeline · Sequence	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. Our signature move.

Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Every organizer doubles as a *skills tool*.

Unit 2 · Citizen Participation (SSP.01–SSP.06)

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 2 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)	ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT	WHERE IN UNIT 2
● SSP.01	Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.	5 Ws · Main Idea & Details · K-W-L	GC.31 responsibilities (T-Chart legal vs. expected); K-W-L to open the unit.
● SSP.02	Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias.	HIPPO · C-E-R	GC.33 media & public opinion (Cause & Effect / HIPPO on a news source).
● SSP.03	Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.	Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn	GC.34 ways to participate (Concept Web); compare parties & elections (Matrix).
● SSP.04	Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.	C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution	GC.31 responsibilities (T-Chart); C-E-R on a civic-duty claim.
● SSP.05	Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.	Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence	GC.32 nomination process (Sequence: primary/caucus → convention → general election).
● SSP.06	Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.	Tennessee Connection · Matrix	Limited in Foundations; primary geographic focus lands in Unit 7 (TN State & Local). Use the ★ Tennessee Connection to bridge.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Two

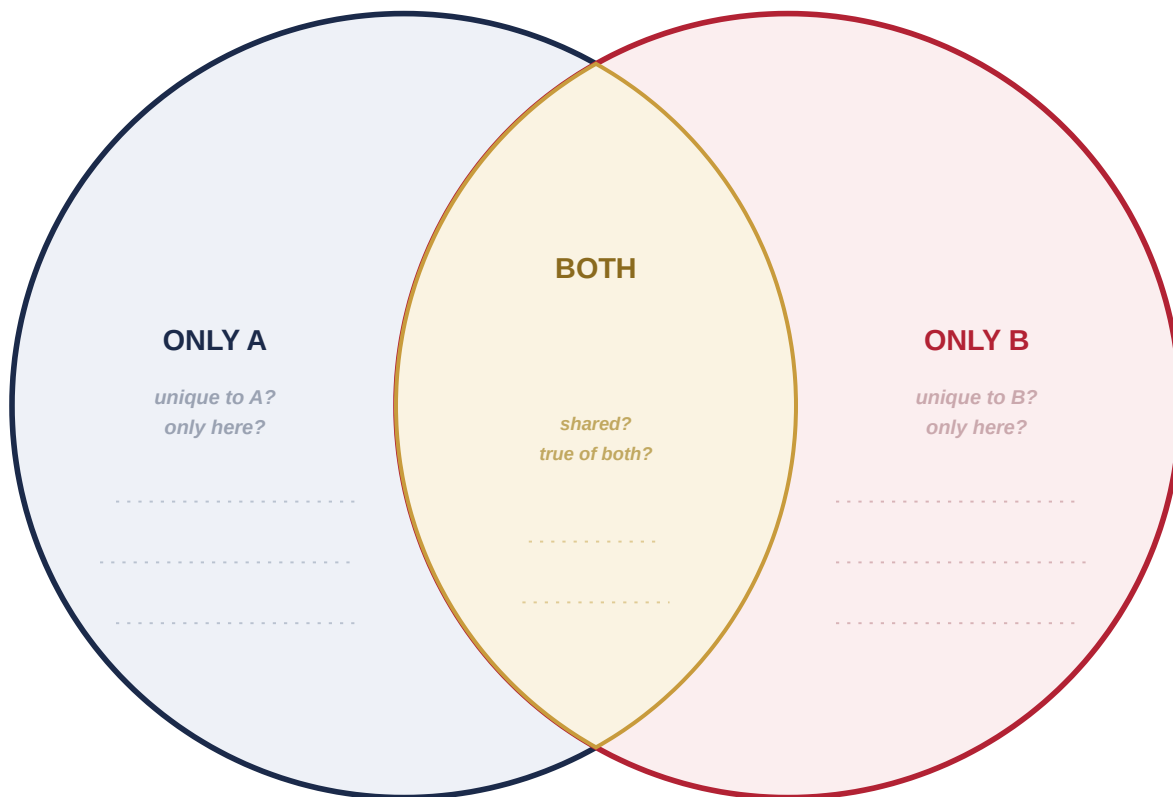
Marzano #1

WHEN · WHY Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

Topic A: _____
write in the left circle

Topic B: _____
write in the right circle



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SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

WHEN · WHY Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.
Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

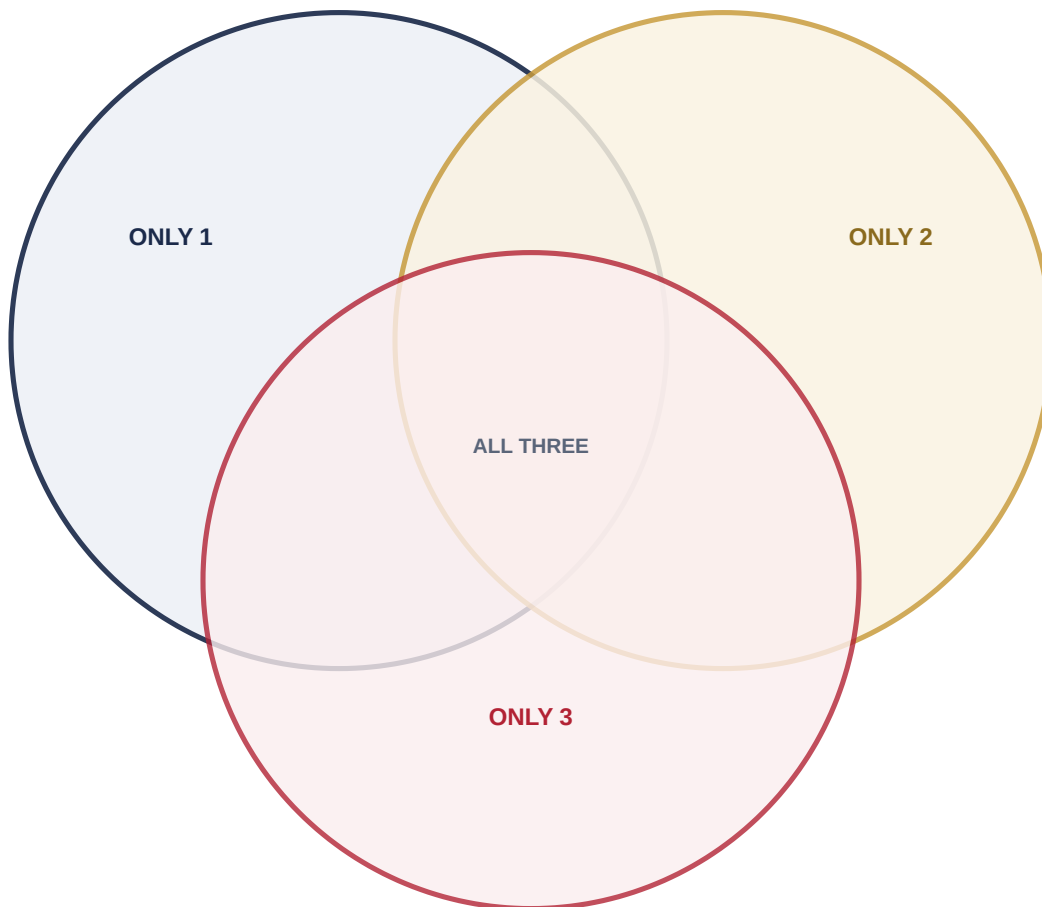
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



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Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

EXTEND

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no text or other markings on the paper.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

	Case 1 name it	Case 2 name it	Case 3 name it
Criterion A			
Criterion B			
Criterion C			
PATTERN	What pattern do you see across the cases? _____		

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Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

EXTEND
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

CAUSES

EFFECTS

WHAT DID IT LEAD TO?

THE EVENT

So what? Which single cause mattered most, and why?

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Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

WHEN · WHY Put events in **order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

Event 2 — what happened?

Event 3 — what happened?

Event 4 — why did it matter?

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SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Concept Web

⌚ 10-15 min

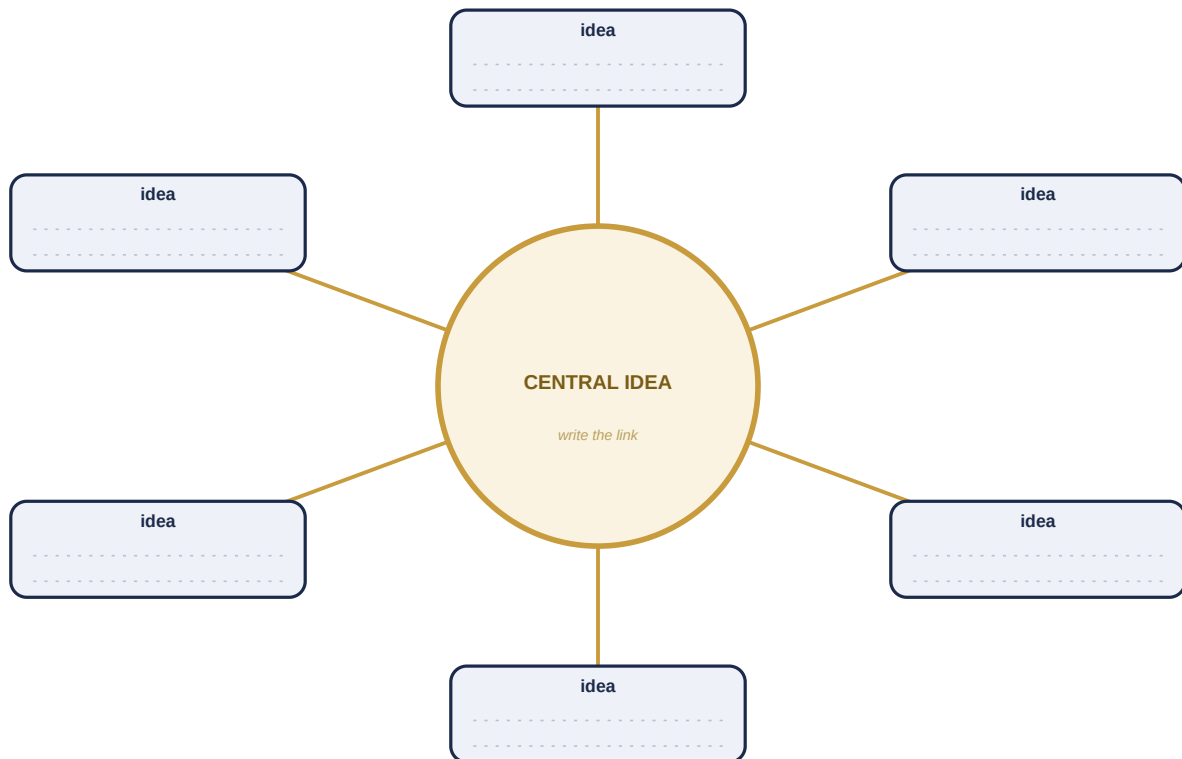
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web

Schema

WHEN · WHY **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.

**MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT** UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

EXTEND

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Main Idea & Details

Summarize

WHEN · WHY Summarize by separating the big idea from the details that support it. *Distinguishing central idea from detail is core disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

In one sentence: the main idea matters because _____

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SCAFFOLD
Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Fill K and W before you start; return to L after the lesson.

[illegible]

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Offer sentence starters: 'I already know...', 'I want to know...', 'I learned...'.

In the L column, note one thing you still wonder — a question for further inquiry.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

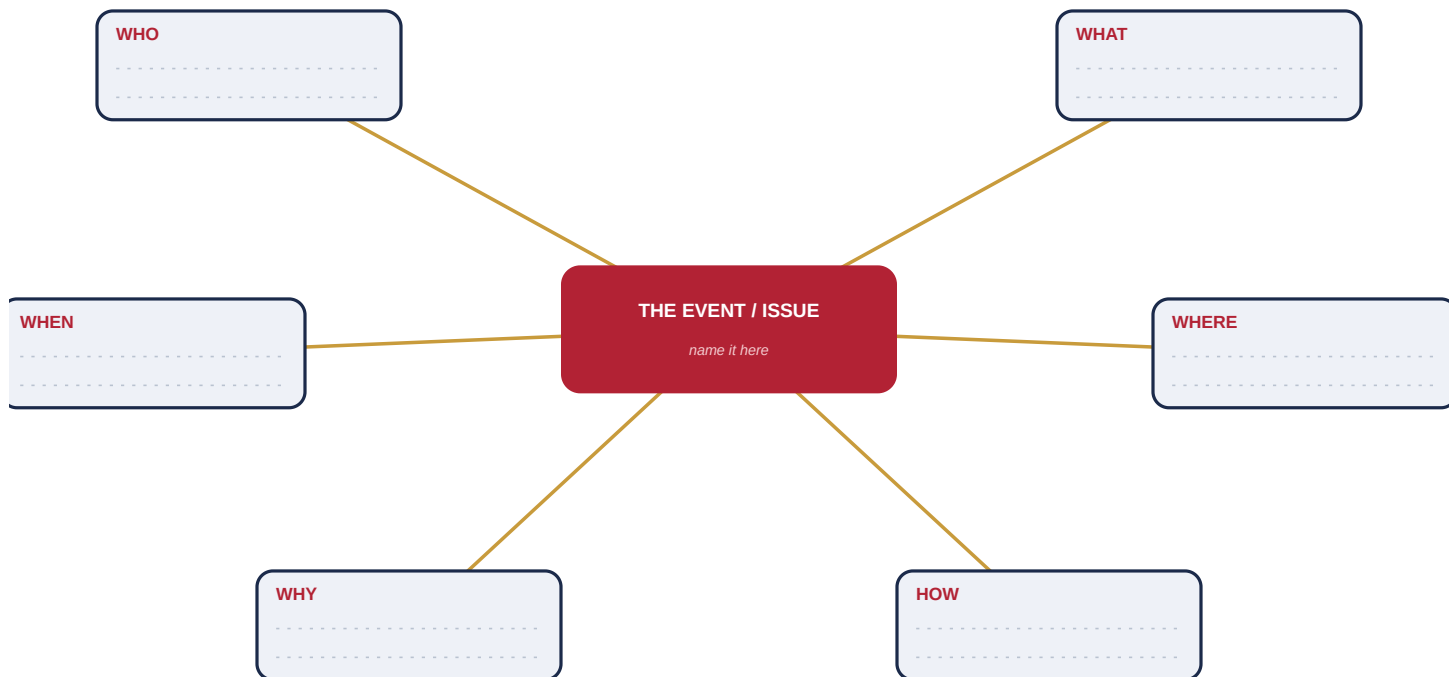
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

5 Ws

SSP.01

WHEN · WHY Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.



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SCAFFOLD

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Problem-Solution

Decision

WHEN · WHY Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Option B: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Best solution: _____ — because _____

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SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Frayer Model — Key Term

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Frayer

Vocabulary

WHEN · WHY Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

DEFINITION (in your words)

CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)

EXAMPLES

EXAMPLES

TERM

write the term

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SCAFFOLD

Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

EXTEND

Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

WHEN · WHY Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.
Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?
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SCAFFOLD

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

EXTEND

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

HIPPO

SSP.02

WHEN · WHY Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: _____ title · author / creator · date · type

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

P

POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

P

PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

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SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

★ TN Connection

Signature Move

Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.

[illegible]

How are they linked? _____

Why the local story matters: _____

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Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.

Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to *and* different from the national one.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Some civic duties are required by law; others are expected of a good citizen but not enforced. Sorting them shows students what a republic *demands* versus what it *depends on*. *Collecting and organizing civic information builds TN Practice SSP.01.*

Sort each responsibility: is it a legal duty (required) or expected of a good citizen?

LEGAL DUTIES required — enforced by law	EXPECTED OF GOOD CITIZENS not required, but the republic needs it
Obey the law what happens if you don't? Pay taxes who is required, and why? Jury duty when are you legally summoned?	Stay informed why did Jefferson say this matters? Vote a right and a responsibility — why? Volunteer / serve how does service strengthen the nation?

Weigh it: Which single responsibility matters most for the well-being of the nation — and why? _____

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UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give the eight responsibilities on cards; students place each under Legal or Expected first.

EXTEND
Pick one 'expected' responsibility and argue whether it should become a legal duty.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY A candidate can't reach the general election without first winning the party's nomination. Mapping the flow shows students how primaries, caucuses, and conventions fit together. *Sequencing a process builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).*

Work down the process. In each box, record how the step chooses or narrows the candidates.

1

PRIMARIES & CAUCUSES — how do party members pick a favorite? (open vs. closed primary; caucus meeting)

2

NATIONAL CONVENTION — how is the nominee made official, and what does the running mate add?

3

GENERAL ELECTION — how do all voters — not just one party — now choose among the nominees?

Weigh it: Washington warned against the “spirit of party.” Do parties help or hurt this process?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

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SCAFFOLD
Provide the three stages on cards; students order them, then add how each narrows the field.

EXTEND
Explain the difference between an open and a closed primary and why a party might prefer each.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

How Media Shapes Public Opinion

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

⌚ 20-25 min

Cause & Effect

SSP.02 · DOK 3

WHEN · WHY The media doesn't just report — by choosing what to cover and how to word it, it influences which issues seem important. Tracing that chain builds a citizen's guard against spin. *Critically examining sources for purpose and bias is TN Practice SSP.02.*

List what the media does on the left; list the effect on public opinion on the right.

CAUSES

STORY SELECTION? FRAMING? POLL WORDING? WHICH VOICES ARE QUOTED?

EFFECTS

WHICH ISSUES SEEM IMPORTANT? WHAT DO PEOPLE COME TO BELIEVE?

PUBLIC OPINION
what people believe matters

Spot the bias: Give one example of wording or framing that could push an audience toward a view.

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SCAFFOLD

Model one cause → effect pair together (e.g., a loaded poll question → a skewed result).

EXTEND

Compare two headlines about the same event and explain how each frames the story differently.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Ways Citizens Participate

⌚ 15-20 min

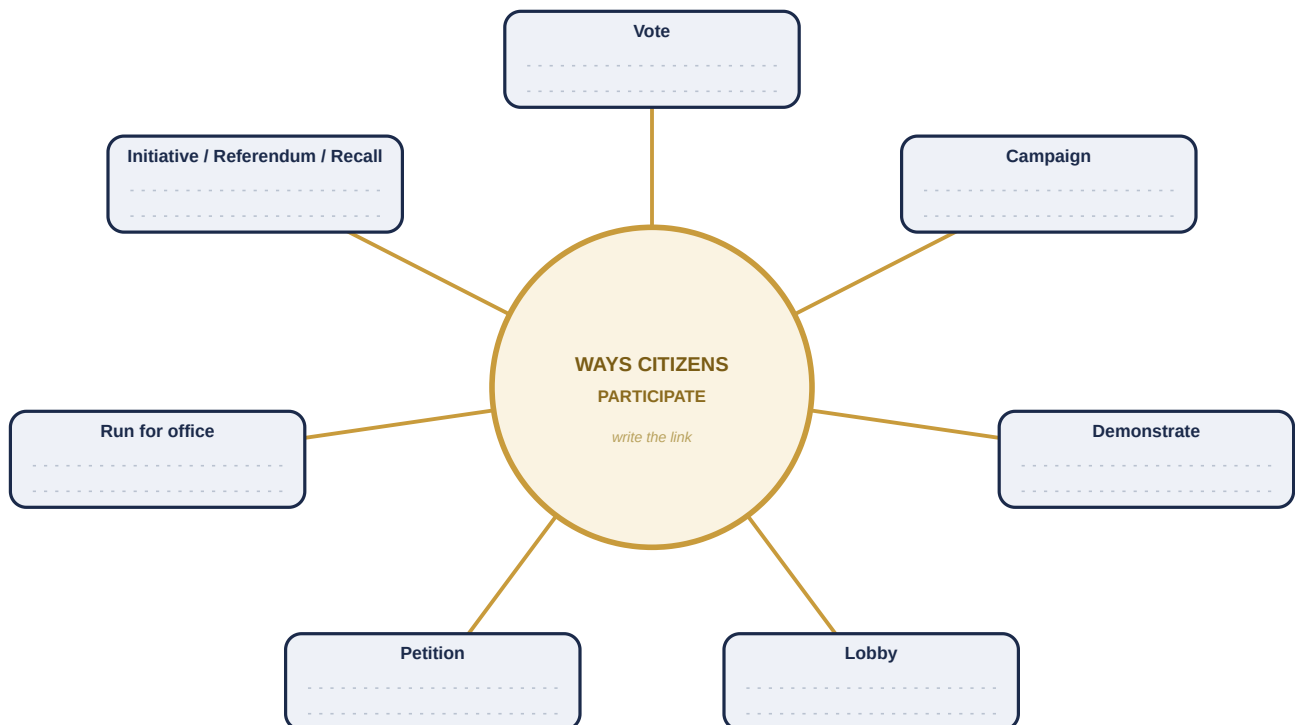
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web · Connect Ideas

SSP.04 · DOK 2

WHEN · WHY Voting is only the beginning. A concept web gathers the many channels — protest, petition, lobbying, running for office, direct democracy — around one hub, so students see participation as a whole toolkit. *Constructing and communicating civic action builds TN Practice SSP.04.*

In each bubble, name a way citizens participate and give one real example.



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SCAFFOLD

Fill two bubbles together (e.g., vote, petition) and model naming a real example for each.

EXTEND

Rank the methods by how much power each gives an ordinary citizen, and defend your top choice.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.